FRONTMATTER_SENTINEL_TITLE: Metadata Handling Test

FRONTMATTER_SENTINEL_AUTHOR_ONE, FRONTMATTER_SENTINEL_AUTHOR_TWO

2026-11-07

Markdown Renderer Test 5: YAML Front Matter

The block above this heading, between the two `---` lines on lines 1 and 55 or so, is **YAML front matter**. It is metadata, not content.

How to Check

Export this file to PDF, then **search the PDF text** (Ctrl+F or Cmd+F) for each of these strings:

Search for	Should be found?
`FRONTMATTER_SENTINEL`	**No** (zero matches, unless the renderer uses the title as a document title, see below)
`sentinel.one@example.com`	No
`FRONTMATTER_SENTINEL_DEEP_VALUE`	No
`FRONTMATTER_SENTINEL_HTML`	No
`draft: true`	No
`BODY_SENTINEL`	**Yes** (appears in the body below)

Allowed exception: some tools deliberately use `title`, `author`, and `date` to build a title block or the PDF document properties. That is acceptable. It is **not** acceptable to see raw YAML such as `tags: [...]`, `config:`, or `abstract: |` as text, a table, a code block, or a heading.

What a Broken Renderer Looks Like

Any of these at the top of the PDF means front matter handling is broken:

- Raw `key: value` lines shown as a paragraph
- The metadata shown as a code block
- The metadata shown as a table
- A horizontal rule at the top followed by one big heading made of the metadata (this happens when `---` after text is parsed as a setext heading underline)
- The `<script>` line appearing as text, or an alert popping up
- Math from the `abstract` or `formula` fields rendered as an equation
- The `price` value `$5.00` causing the following text to be treated as math

---

Body Content (Must Render Normally)

BODY_SENTINEL: this paragraph must appear in the PDF. If the page starts here, with the H1 title above it, the metadata was stripped correctly.

Code Highlighting

```
def check(front_matter_hidden: bool) -> str:
    return "pass" if front_matter_hidden else "fail"
```

Links

- Pandoc metadata docs
- Jekyll front matter
- https://example.com

Math

Inline: $a^2 + b^2 = c^2$.

$$\int_0^1 x^2 \, dx = \frac{1}{3} \tag{1}$$

Mermaid

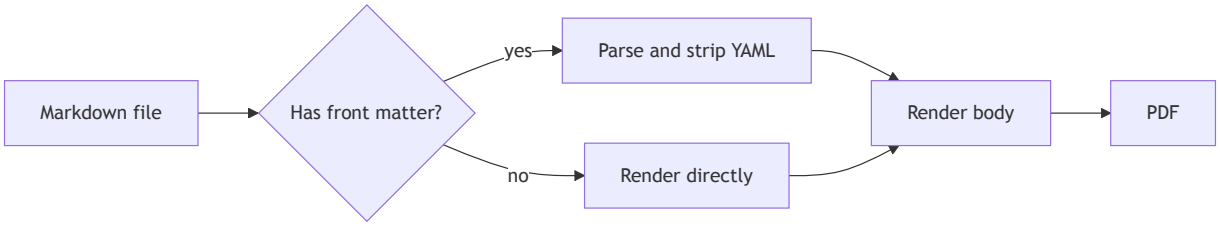


Figure 1: Mermaid diagram 1

Tricky Cases: Content That Looks Like Front Matter

These body elements must still render as **body content**, even though they resemble front matter.

1. Horizontal rule between paragraphs

Paragraph above the rule.

Paragraph below the rule. A horizontal line should be visible between the two paragraphs.

2. A second `---` ... `---` block in the body

The next block is NOT at the top of the file, so it is not front matter. It should render as: a rule, a paragraph, then another rule.

---

title: this is not metadata author: it is just text between two rules

---

Expected: two horizontal rules with the two `key: value` lines visible between them. (In some parsers the first line followed by `---` becomes a heading; either way the text should be visible, not silently removed.)

3. A YAML code block in the body

This one SHOULD be visible, highlighted as YAML:

```yaml
---
title: Visible example front matter
tags: [one, two, three]
nested:
  key: value
---
```

4. Front matter shown as an example inside a markdown fence

```
---
title: Example inside a fence
---

# Heading inside a fence
```

Expected: shown literally as code, not parsed.

5. Text immediately followed by dashes (setext heading)

Setext heading text

The line above should render as an H2 heading, which is normal Markdown behavior and different from front matter.

6. Table with dashes

Key	Value
title	normal table cell
draft	also normal

Final Checklist

- ☐ PDF does not show `tags:`, `config:`, `abstract:`, `author:` lines as text
- ☐ Searching the PDF for `FRONTMATTER_SENTINEL` returns nothing (or only a title block / PDF properties if the tool uses them)
- ☐ No `<script>` text and no alert from the `html` field
- ☐ Math from the metadata did not render as an equation
- ☐ The page begins with the H1 “Markdown Renderer Test 5”, not a block of metadata
- ☐ `BODY_SENTINEL` is found in the PDF text
- ☐ Code highlighting, link, math, and Mermaid below the metadata still work
- ☐ A rule in the body renders as a rule, not as front matter
- ☐ The body `---` block (case 2) is visible, not swallowed as metadata
- ☐ The YAML fenced block (case 3) is visible and highlighted
- ☐ The fenced markdown example (case 4) is literal code
- ☐ Setext heading (case 5) renders as an H2